

To get the last known location in an app, you must **implement specific location services provided by the device's operating system**, primarily for Android and iOS development. Both platforms offer APIs to retrieve a device's last recorded location, provided the user has granted the necessary permissions. 

For Android App Development

The recommended method is to use the **Fused Location Provider**, part of Google Play services location APIs. This API manages underlying location technology and optimizes battery usage. 

Key Steps:

1. **Set Up Google Play Services:** Add the necessary dependency (`com.google.android.gms:play-services-location`) to your app's `build.gradle` file.
2. **Specify App Permissions:** Request location permissions in your app's manifest file. You should typically request `ACCESS_COARSE_LOCATION` or `ACCESS_FINE_LOCATION`, and also handle runtime permission requests.
3. **Create a Location Services Client:** Initialize an instance of the `FusedLocationProviderClient` in your activity's `onCreate()` method.
4. **Get the Last Known Location:** Use the `getLastLocation()` method of the client. This returns a `Task` that you can add a listener to, which provides a `Location` object if successful.

java 

```
fusedLocationClient.getLastLocation()
    .addOnSuccessListener(this, new OnSuccessListener<Location>() {
        @Override
        public void onSuccess(Location location) {
            // Got last known location. In some rare situations this can
            if (location != null) {
                // Logic to handle location object
            }
        }
    });
```

The location object might be null if location services were recently disabled or the device has never recorded its location.

For iOS App Development

For iOS apps, you use the **Core Location** framework.

Key Steps:

1. **Configure Info.plist:** Add keys to your app's `Info.plist` file explaining why you need location data, such as `NSLocationWhenInUseUsageDescription` or `NSLocationAlwaysAndWhenInUseUsageDescription`.
2. **Request Authorization:** Prompt the user to grant location permissions using a `CLLocationManager` instance.
3. **Retrieve Location:** Use the location manager to access the current or last known location data.

As an App User

If you are a user trying to find the last known location of a lost device, you can use built-in services:

- **Android:** Use [Google's Find My Device](#) service via a web browser or another Android device.
- **iOS:** Use the [Find My app](#) on another Apple device, or log into iCloud on a web browser.

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 Android Developers

Locate a device in Find My on iPhone - Apple Support

See the location of your device on a map. You can see your device's current or last known location in the Find My app. Tap Devices...

 Apple Support



Use Find My to locate your lost Apple device or AirTag

